

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Integration of the Princely States & the Making of the Republic - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing

Integration of the Princely States & the Making of the Republic
REFRESHED TEACHING NAVIGATION — BASIC/CORE FIRST

01 FOUNDATION — INDEPENDENCE WAS NOT INTEGRATION: THE PROBLEM THE LAPSE Mains: Open any integration answer with the lapse, because it	02 FOUNDATION — HOW MANY STATES: THE DISCIPLINE BEHIND MORE THAN 560 Core claim: The number of princely states is a trap disguised as a fact.
03 FOUNDATION — THE STATES DEPARTMENT: A MINISTER, A SECRETARY AND A MACHINE Mains: Use the department as the institutional evidence unit	04 CORE — THE THREE-SUBJECT FORMULA AND WHY ITS NARROWNESS WORKED Precise definition: The instrument of Accession was the standard legal
05 CORE — ATTLEE AND JINNAH: THE ENCOURAGEMENT THE PRINCES RECEIVED Attlee later qualified the British position by expressing the hope that	06 CORE — TWO PRESSURES ON THE PRINCES: THEIR OWN PEOPLE AND PARTITION Core claim: Accession was never a private transaction between a
07 CORE — ACCESSION, MERGER, DEMOCRATISATION, INCORPORATION: FOUR The commonest structural error in this topic is to treat accession as	08 CORE — JUNAGADH: THE RULER-SUBJECT MISMATCH AND FEBRUARY 1948 Core claim: Junagadh is the case in which the accession formula
09 CORE — HYDERABAD: STANDSTILL, RAZAKARS AND SEPTEMBER 1948 Operation Polo is Hyderabad in September 1948; do not attach it to	10 CORE — KASHMIR: OCTOBER 1947, ACCESSION, AND DISCIPLINED RESTRAINT Kashmir is the case in which the accession formula was overtaken by
11 CORE — THE FOUR-VARIABLE COMPARISON ENGINE FOR THE THREE HARD CASES The three problem states did not pose the same problem; use the	12 CORE — UNIONS AND MERGERS: MAKING UNVIABLE STATES ADMINISTRABLE Precise definition: Merger and union formation denote the second
13 CORE SYNTHESIS — PRIVY PURSES AND PRIVILEGES: THE PRICE CARRIED FORWARD Rulers of the major states received privy purses in return for	14 CORE SYNTHESIS — FROM ACCEDING STATE TO CITIZEN: 1949 AND 1950 Core claim: Integration was completed by constitutional means rather
15 CORE SYNTHESIS — COMMEMORATION AND CHRONOLOGY: READING EKTA DIWAS AS A Mains: Use this session as the model for handling any anniversary	

Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Integration of the Princely States & the Making of the Republic - Solved Practice Workbook 5

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION 5

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?	5
Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?	5
Q3. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?	6
Q4. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?	6
Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The divided princely response of April 1947?	6
Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The divided princely response of April 1947?	7
Q7. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The divided princely response of April 1947?	7
Q8. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The divided princely response of April 1947?	7
Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?	8
Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?	8
Q11. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?	8
Q12. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?	9
Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The States Department created on 27 June 1947?	9
Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under The States Department created on 27 June 1947?	9
Q15. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The States Department created on 27 June 1947?	10
Q16. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The States Department created on 27 June 1947?	10
Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The three-subject accession formula?	10
Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The three-subject accession formula?	11
Q19. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The three-subject accession formula?	11
Q20. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The three-subject accession formula?	11
Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?	12
Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?	12
Q23. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?	12
Q24. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?	13
Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The counting discipline of more than 560 states?	13
Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The counting discipline of more than 560 states?	13
Q27. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The counting discipline of more than 560 states?	14

Q28. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The counting discipline of more than 560 states?	14
Q29. Which statement correctly identifies All but three acceded by the transfer of power?	14
Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under All but three acceded by the transfer of power?	15
Q31. Which option should a candidate retain when revising All but three acceded by the transfer of power?	15
Q32. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about All but three acceded by the transfer of power?	15
Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?	16
Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?	16
Q35. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?	16
Q36. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?	17
Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?	17
Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?	17
Q39. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?	18
Q40. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?	18
Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?	18
Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?	19
Q43. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?	19
Q44. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?	20
Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?	20
Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?	20
Q47. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?	21
Q48. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?	21
Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?	21
Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?	22
Q51. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?	22
Q52. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?	22
Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The second stage of integration from December 1947?	23
Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The second stage of integration from December 1947?	23
Q55. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The second stage of integration from December 1947?	23
Q56. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The second stage of integration from December 1947?	24
Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?	24
Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?	24
Q59. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?	25

Q60. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?	25
Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?	25
Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?	26
Q63. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?	26
Q64. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?	26
Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?	27
Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?	27
Q67. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?	27
Q68. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?	28
Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?	28
Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?	29
Q71. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?	29
Q72. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?	29
Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?	30
Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?	30
Q75. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?	30
Q76. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?	31
Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?	31
Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?	32
Q79. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?	32
Q80. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?	32

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE 33

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 Mains GS-I Q3	33
PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018-2026 Prelims GS-I	34
ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS	34
ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS	35
ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS	36
ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS	37
ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS	38
ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS	39

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?

A. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. B. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. C. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. D. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed.

Answer: A. Explanation: The local OCR text of India After Independence records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?

A. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. B. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. C. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. D. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.

Answer: B. Explanation: The local OCR text of India After Independence records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q3. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?

A. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. B. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. C. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. D. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession.

Answer: C. Explanation: The local OCR text of India After Independence records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q4. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Attlee's paramountcy announcement of 20 February 1947?

A. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. B. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. C. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. D. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves.

Answer: D. Explanation: The local OCR text of India After Independence records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The divided princely response of April 1947?

A. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. B. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. C. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. D. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side.

Answer: A. Explanation: A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for

independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The divided princely response of April 1947?

A. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. B. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. C. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. D. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.

Answer: B. Explanation: A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q7. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The divided princely response of April 1947?

A. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. B. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. C. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. D. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.

Answer: C. Explanation: A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q8. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The divided princely response of April 1947?

A. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. B. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. C. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. D. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed.

Answer: D. Explanation: A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?

A. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. B. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. C. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. D. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.

Answer: A. Explanation: M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?

A. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. B. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. C. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. D. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.

Answer: B. Explanation: M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q11. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?

A. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. B. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. C. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. D. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession.

Answer: C. Explanation: M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. This distinction

preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q12. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Jinnah's declaration of 18 June 1947?

A. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. B. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. C. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. D. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side.

Answer: D. Explanation: M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies The States Department created on 27 June 1947?

A. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. B. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. C. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. D. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under The States Department created on 27 June 1947?

A. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. B. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. C. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. D. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q15. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The States Department created on 27 June 1947?

A. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. B. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. C. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. D. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q16. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The States Department created on 27 June 1947?

A. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. B. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. C. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. D. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The three-subject accession formula?

A. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. B. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. C. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. D. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The three-subject accession formula?

A. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. B. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. C. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. D. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q19. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The three-subject accession formula?

A. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. B. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. C. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. D. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q20. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The three-subject accession formula?

A. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. B. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. C. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. D. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. This

distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?

A. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. B. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. C. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. D. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene.

Answer: A. Explanation: British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?

A. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. B. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. C. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. D. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession.

Answer: B. Explanation: British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q23. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?

A. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. B. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. C. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. D. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene.

Answer: C. Explanation: British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had

to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q24. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred?

A. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. B. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. C. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. D. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession.

Answer: D. Explanation: British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies The counting discipline of more than 560 states?

A. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. B. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. C. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. D. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession.

Answer: A. Explanation: There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under The counting discipline of more than 560 states?

A. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. B. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. C. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. D. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene.

Answer: B. Explanation: There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than

560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q27. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The counting discipline of more than 560 states?

A. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. B. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. C. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. D. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi.

Answer: C. Explanation: There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q28. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The counting discipline of more than 560 states?

A. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. B. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. C. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. D. There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure.

Answer: D. Explanation: There were more than 560 princely states at independence, and the familiar totals of 562 and 565 differ by counting convention rather than by historical fact, so a safe answer writes more than 560 and never asserts either total as the single correct figure. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies All but three acceded by the transfer of power?

A. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. B. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. C. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. D. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift.

Answer: A. Explanation: Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. This distinction preserves the source-backed

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under All but three acceded by the transfer of power?

A. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. B. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. C. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. D. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift.

Answer: B. Explanation: Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q31. Which option should a candidate retain when revising All but three acceded by the transfer of power?

A. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. B. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. C. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. D. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q32. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about All but three acceded by the transfer of power?

A. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. B. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession.

Answer: D. Explanation: Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?

A. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. B. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. C. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. D. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?

A. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. B. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. C. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. D. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi.

Answer: B. Explanation: Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q35. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?

A. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. B. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. C. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. D. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration.

Answer: C. Explanation: Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly

Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q36. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Junagadh: a ruler at odds with his own people?

A. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. B. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene.

Answer: D. Explanation: Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?

A. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. B. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. C. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. D. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi.

Answer: A. Explanation: Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?

A. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. B. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. C. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. D. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would

make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement.

Answer: B. Explanation: Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q39. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?

A. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. B. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. C. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. D. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim.

Answer: C. Explanation: Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q40. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Kashmir: invasion in October 1947 before accession?

A. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. B. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift.

Answer: D. Explanation: Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?

A. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. B. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. C. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. D. The Government of India signed a standstill

agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement.

Answer: A. Explanation: Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?

A. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. B. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.

Answer: B. Explanation: Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q43. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?

A. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. B. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. C. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. D. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.

Answer: C. Explanation: Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q44. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Sheikh Abdullah and the National Conference?

A. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. B. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. C. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. D. Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi.

Answer: D. Explanation: Kashmir's principal popular political force, the National Conference under Sheikh Abdullah, favoured accession to India and Abdullah was installed as head of the state's administration, which is why the Kashmir case cannot be reduced to a private transaction between a Maharaja and New Delhi. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?

A. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. B. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?

A. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. B. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q47. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?

A. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. B. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. C. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. D. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q48. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Hyderabad's standstill agreement of November 1947?

A. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. B. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. C. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. D. The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?

A. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. B. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC

elimination.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?

A. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. B. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. C. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. D. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q51. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?

A. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. B. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. C. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. D. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q52. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The reference to the United Nations on 30 December 1947?

A. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. B. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. C. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. D. The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Government of India referred the Kashmir problem to the Security Council of the United Nations on 30 December 1947 asking for vacation of aggression, and this package records that referral and the fighting that followed without narrating any later contested political or constitutional claim. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies The second stage of integration from December 1947?

A. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. B. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. C. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. D. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under The second stage of integration from December 1947?

A. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. B. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. C. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. D. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union.

Answer: B. Explanation: The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q55. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The second stage of integration from December 1947?

A. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. B. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. C. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. D. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.

Answer: C. Explanation: The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q56. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The second stage of integration from December 1947?

A. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. B. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. C. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. D. The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration.

Answer: D. Explanation: The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?

A. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. B. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. C. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. D. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here.

Answer: A. Explanation: A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?

A. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. B. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. C. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. D. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union.

Answer: B. Explanation: A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because

no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q59. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?

A. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. B. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. C. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. D. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.

Answer: C. Explanation: A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q60. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Junagadh plebiscite of February 1948?

A. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. B. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. C. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. D. A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.

Answer: D. Explanation: A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?

A. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. B. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. C. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. D. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.

Answer: A. Explanation: Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian

Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?

A. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. B. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. C. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. D. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse.

Answer: B. Explanation: Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q63. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?

A. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. B. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. C. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. D. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014.

Answer: C. Explanation: Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q64. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Operation Polo and Hyderabad in September 1948?

A. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. B. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. C. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. D. Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here.

Answer: D. Explanation: Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?

A. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. B. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. C. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. D. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.

Answer: A. Explanation: Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?

A. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. B. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. C. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. D. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves.

Answer: B. Explanation: Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q67. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?

A. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. B. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. C. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab

States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. D. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed.

Answer: C. Explanation: Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q68. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Unions, mergers and the making of administrable units?

A. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. B. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. C. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. D. Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union.

Answer: D. Explanation: Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?

A. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. B. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. C. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. D. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?

A. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. B. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. C. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. D. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q71. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?

A. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. B. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. C. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. D. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q72. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Privy purses as a continuing cost, not an immediate abolition?

A. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. B. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. C. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. D. Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the

repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?

A. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. B. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. C. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. D. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?

A. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. B. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. C. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. D. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q75. Which option should a candidate retain when revising Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?

A. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. B. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. C. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. D. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed

additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q76. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about Adoption on 26 November 1949 and commencement on 26 January 1950?

A. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. B. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. C. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. D. The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?

A. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. B. The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves. C. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. D. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?

A. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. B. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. C. A minority of states showed realism by joining the Constituent Assembly in April 1947 while the majority stayed away, and Travancore, Bhopal and Hyderabad publicly announced a desire for independent status, so princely opinion was already divided before any instrument was signed. D. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q79. Which option should a candidate retain when revising The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?

A. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. B. M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side. C. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. D. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

Q80. Which statement avoids a common matching trap about The Sardar Patel 150th anniversary commemoration?

A. The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment. B. Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone. C. British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession. D. The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014. This distinction preserves the source-backed chronology and prevents cross-matching errors in UPSC elimination.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Historical PYQ Integration (2018-2023)

Status: Question-level PYQ demand is integrated into this owner. **Provenance:** Audited local official-paper routing ledgers: _PYQ-ROUTING-MAINS-GS1-GS2-ESSAY-2018-2023.md.

- **Years represented:** 2021
- **Paper(s):** GS-I
- **Routed question demands:** 1

Year	Paper	Q	PYQ demand (neutral rendering)	Directive / format	Source status	Owner requirement
2021	GS-I	3	Administrative and socio-cultural issues in integrating princely states	Assess · 10 marks · 150 words	Routed to owning topic	Prepare context, core dimensions, evidence/examples, counterpoint and a concise conclusion.

What this owner must now support

- Administrative and socio-cultural issues in integrating princely states

The table integrates the examinable demand and paper metadata. It does not turn an unkeyed objective question into a solved answer, and it does not claim that lexical presence alone proves full conceptual sufficiency.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 Mains GS-I Q3

Demand: Assess the main administrative issues and socio-cultural problems in the integration process of Indian Princely States. (Answer in 150 words)

Status: verbatim-official-stem-verified-locally in the repository export of the 2021 General Studies Paper I question paper, and routed to this owner at 10 marks by the audited local Mains routing ledger

Model solution / safe handling: Open by separating the two halves of the demand, because the directive is Assess and the examiner has named administrative issues and socio-cultural problems as distinct heads. On the administrative side, state that paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred, so a department had to be built from nothing: Patel took additional charge of the States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as Secretary, and the machinery had to standardise instruments, absorb more than 560 units of wildly unequal size, merge unviable states into unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, and then extend courts, services, revenue systems and elections into territories that had never known them. On the socio-cultural side, note the dynastic legitimacy of rulers, the survival of titles, successions and ceremonial privileges through the privy-purse settlement, the very uneven pace of democratisation inside former states, and the communal and regional sensitivities visible in Junagadh's ruler-subject mismatch and in the Razakar mobilisation in Hyderabad. Add one qualification: the process mixed persuasion, popular pressure, plebiscite and, in September 1948, force, so a single administrative narrative is inadequate. Close by grading the outcome: the administrative problem was solved quickly and the socio-cultural one slowly, which is why the Constitution's grant of a single citizenship on 26 January 1950 mattered more than any individual instrument of accession.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 Mains GS-I Q3", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 1 - 2021 Mains GS-I Q3”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018-2026 Prelims GS-I

Demand: No objective question in the audited local Prelims routing ledgers for 2018-2023, 2024-2025 or 2026 is routed to this owner.

Status: unresolved-locally; the package asserts no Prelims stem, no option set and no answer letter for this topic

Model solution / safe handling: Treat this as a transparent zero-direct-PYQ audit rather than as a gap to be filled with an invented question. The examinable surface is nevertheless dense and matchable: paramountcy lapsed rather than being transferred; the Instrument of Accession covered Defence, External Affairs and Communications; Operation Polo is Hyderabad in September 1948; the Junagadh plebiscite is February 1948; the Kashmir tribal invasion is October 1947; the Constitution was adopted on 26 November 1949 and commenced on 26 January 1950. Revise those as matching pairs of actor, instrument, place and date, and do not relabel any adjacent Polity or International Relations question as a Modern History Prelims PYQ for this owner.

Demand decoding: Treat “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018-2026 Prelims GS-I” as a statement-level chronology and attribution problem: verify every date, Act/provision, person, organisation, region and causal claim independently, without inventing an official key.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the tested time window; separate event/enactment/commencement; match each actor and provision; eliminate the closest distractor with one named record, treaty, session or regional fact.

Why this earns marks: It preserves exact chronology and answer-text mapping, uses named evidence and keeps inferred elimination distinct from an official key.

How to improve this answer: For “PYQ DEMAND CARD 2 - 2018-2026 Prelims GS-I”, add one explicit line showing why the nearest distractor fails on date, legal status, geography, attribution or degree.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Assess the significance of the lapse of British paramountcy for the integration of the princely states. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The lapse of paramountcy converted integration from an inheritance into a construction project, and the speed of the Indian response between June and August 1947 is what prevented that legal vacuum from hardening into a political one.

Evidence spine:

- British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession.
- The local OCR text of *India After Independence* records Clement Attlee's announcement of 20 February 1947 that His Majesty's Government did not intend to hand over their powers and obligations under paramountcy to any government of British India, a statement that several large princes read as a licence to claim sovereignty for themselves.
- M.A. Jinnah publicly declared on 18 June 1947 that the states would be independent sovereign states on the termination of paramountcy and were free to remain independent if they so desired, which encouraged the largest

princes and made speed indispensable on the Indian side.

- Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The lapse of paramountcy converted integration from an inheritance into a construction project, and the speed of the Indian response between June and August 1947 is what prevented that legal vacuum from hardening into a political one.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the significance of the lapse of British paramountcy for the integration of the...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the significance of the lapse of British paramountcy for the integration of the...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain why the Instrument of Accession initially demanded only three subjects from acceding states. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The instrument's narrowness was its strength: by asking only for Defence, External Affairs and Communications it demanded exactly what no state could supply for itself, which made acceptance cheap in appearance and decisive in substance.

Evidence spine:

- The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.
- Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.
- Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession.
- The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The instrument's narrowness was its strength: by asking only for Defence, External Affairs and Communications it demanded exactly what no state could supply for itself, which made acceptance cheap in appearance and decisive in substance.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain why the Instrument of Accession initially demanded only three subjects from...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise three named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain why the Instrument of Accession initially demanded only three subjects from...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Compare Junagadh, Hyderabad and Kashmir as three distinct failures of the accession formula rather than three versions of one problem. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The three cases failed the formula in three different ways - a ruler at odds with his people, a ruler seeking sovereignty, and a ruler paralysed between two dominions - which is precisely why three different instruments were used to settle them.

Evidence spine:

- Junagadh was a small Saurashtra state surrounded by Indian territory and without geographical contiguity with Pakistan, yet its Nawab announced accession to Pakistan, its overwhelmingly Hindu population organised a movement that forced him to flee, and its Dewan Shah Nawaz Bhutto then invited the Government of India to intervene.
- Tribal invaders entered Kashmir in October 1947 and pushed towards Srinagar, Maharaja Hari Singh appealed to India for military assistance, and troops were flown in only after the Instrument of Accession had been signed, so invasion preceded accession and accession preceded the airlift.
- The Government of India signed a standstill agreement with the Nizam of Hyderabad in November 1947 in the hope that negotiation and representative government inside the state would make merger easier, so force in Hyderabad came after, and not instead of, a documented attempt at settlement.
- A plebiscite held in Junagadh in February 1948 went in favour of joining India, and although the local source describes that result as overwhelming, this package states no percentage because no audited polling figure is held anywhere in the repository.
- Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The three cases failed the formula in three different ways - a ruler at odds with his people, a ruler seeking sovereignty, and a ruler paralysed between two dominions - which is precisely why three different instruments were used to settle them.

Demand decoding: The directive **compare** requires a direct position on "Compare Junagadh, Hyderabad and Kashmir as three distinct failures of the accession formula...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Compare Junagadh, Hyderabad and Kashmir as three distinct failures of the accession formula...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Trace the process by which accession in 1947 was converted into administrative and constitutional integration. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Integration was a sequence and not an event: accession on three subjects, then merger and the creation of unions, then democratisation inside the former states, and finally constitutional incorporation that dissolved princely subjecthood into citizenship.

Evidence spine:

- The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration.
- Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union.
- Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse.
- The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Integration was a sequence and not an event: accession on three subjects, then merger and the creation of unions, then democratisation inside the former states, and finally constitutional incorporation that dissolved princely subjecthood into citizenship.

Demand decoding: The directive **trace** requires a direct position on “Trace the process by which accession in 1947 was converted into administrative and...”, coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise five named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For “Trace the process by which accession in 1947 was converted into administrative and...”, replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: "Integration succeeded because it asked for little at the moment when refusing anything was impossible." Critically examine. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: The sequencing thesis explains most of the outcome but not all of it: the narrow demand and the moment of maximum uncertainty carried the great majority of states, while popular movements, financial concessions and, in one case, force carried the remainder.

Evidence spine:

- British paramountcy over the princely states lapsed when British rule ended on 15 August 1947 and it was never transferred to India or Pakistan, so the Union's authority over princely India had to be constructed by agreement and pressure rather than inherited by legal succession.
- The Instrument of Accession asked acceding states to transfer only three subjects - Defence, External Affairs and Communications - a deliberately narrow demand that covered precisely what no princely state could exercise for itself while leaving internal administration untouched for the moment.
- Every state except Junagadh, Jammu and Kashmir and Hyderabad had acceded to India by 15 August 1947, so the three famous crisis cases were exceptions inside an overwhelmingly successful negotiation and not the normal pattern of accession.
- The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration.
- Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse.
- Hyderabad was integrated in September 1948 through the operation commonly called Operation Polo or the Police Action, after which the Nizam surrendered and acceded to the Indian Union, and no casualty or troop figure for that episode is asserted here.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: The sequencing thesis explains most of the outcome but not all of it: the narrow demand and the moment of maximum uncertainty carried the great majority of states, while popular movements, financial concessions and, in one case, force carried the remainder.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Integration succeeded because it asked for little at the moment when refusing anything was...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For "Integration succeeded because it asked for little at the moment when refusing anything was...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Examine how the territorial accession of 1947 was completed by the constitutional settlement of 1950.
Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Accession created a Union of acceding states; the Constitution created a republic of citizens, and it is the second event, not the first, that made integration irreversible by removing the legal category of a prince's subject.

Evidence spine:

- Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel assumed additional charge of the newly created States Department on 27 June 1947 with V.P. Menon as its Secretary, so integration was the work of a named minister, a named secretary and a department, and never of one man acting alone.
- The second and harder stage of full integration began in December 1947, when smaller states were merged with neighbouring provinces or grouped into new unions, so accession was only the first of two distinct achievements and never the whole of integration.
- Large numbers of small states were consolidated into new unions such as Madhya Bharat, Rajasthan, the Patiala and East Punjab States Union, Saurashtra and Travancore-Cochin, while Mysore, Hyderabad and Jammu and Kashmir retained their original form as separate states of the Union.
- Rulers who surrendered power received privy purses and retained titles, succession and ceremonial privileges, and these settlements were not abolished during the initial integration; the repository owner dates their abolition to 1971, and this package asserts no amount for any purse.
- The Constituent Assembly, presided over by Dr Rajendra Prasad with B.R. Ambedkar chairing the Drafting Committee, adopted the Constitution on 26 November 1949 and it came into force on 26 January 1950, which is the date on which India became a republic and princely subjects became citizens.
- The Ministry of Culture records a two-year commemoration of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 150th birth anniversary launched at the Statue of Unity on 31 October 2024, and a PIB Backgrounder of 30 October 2025 records that Rashtriya Ekta Diwas is observed annually on 31 October and was first celebrated in 2014.

Balance: Distinguish intention from outcome, identify regional or social variation, and avoid treating a formal measure as complete implementation.

Conclusion: Accession created a Union of acceding states; the Constitution created a republic of citizens, and it is the second event, not the first, that made integration irreversible by removing the legal category of a prince's subject.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine how the territorial accession of 1947 was completed by the constitutional...", coverage of every clause, chronological-causal analysis, named evidence, a counter-position and a qualified verdict.

Detailed examiner-grade model status: The solved analysis above is the executable content base. Preserve its exact chronology, named evidence, causal logic, counter-position and qualification.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, open with a two-sentence thesis; organise six to eight named Acts, events, organisations, regions, primary records or scholarly positions as claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification; reserve the final lines for a graded conclusion.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, distinguishes dates and policy stages, connects evidence to mechanism, recognises regional/social variation and avoids teleology or hero worship.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine how the territorial accession of 1947 was completed by the constitutional...", replace the weakest generalisation with one additional named primary/official record or attributed scholarly interpretation and state exactly what it cannot prove.